



raga · accounts

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

One payment. Four problems.

We follow a single cement bill from the day it is asked for to the day the vendor takes the money — and fix the four things that go wrong on the way.

Which date do we use?

Three different amounts

Deleting changes numbers

The 14-day hole



Which date is the real one?

Asked 2 Aug · approved 4 Aug · money gone 25 Aug



₹10,000 or ₹8,000?

Both — and the vendor's book says a third thing



Delete one row, the rest shift up

PRN293 quietly becomes PRN292



Cheque written, but not yet taken

For 14 days it exists nowhere

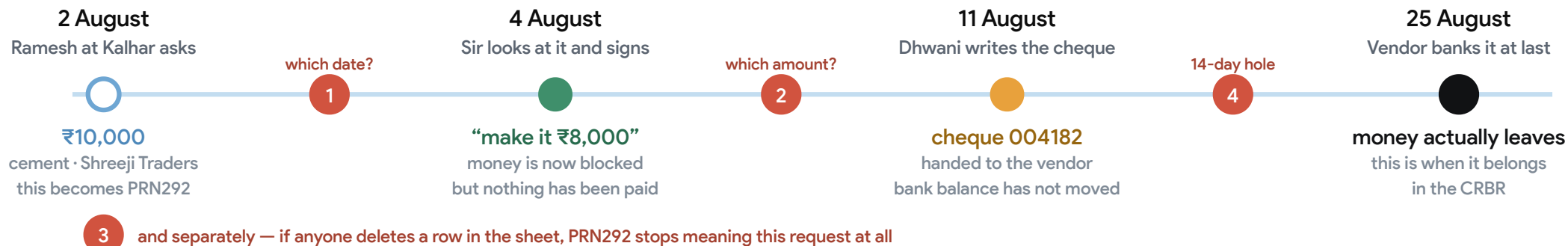
FOR
Accounts team & management

COMPANION TO
The full architecture deck

DATE
12 August 2026

One cement bill, start to finish

Everything in this document is about this one payment. Four things go wrong along the way — marked in red below.



1 Which date do we use?

The sheet has one date column. But there are three real dates and they are all weeks apart.

2 Which amount is right?

Ramesh says ₹10,000. Sir says ₹8,000. The vendor's book says ₹10,000. Everyone is telling the truth.

3 Numbers move when you delete

Delete one row and every request below it silently takes someone else's number.

4 The cheque disappears

Between 11 and 25 August the cheque is out of our hands but shows up nowhere. If it is never banked, nobody ever knows.



All four are the same mistake

wearing four different faces

The sheet gives us one box for each fact — one date, one amount, one number, one row. But real life has several of each, and they arrive at different times. Every fix in this document is the same move: stop squeezing three true things into one box.

Which date do we write down?

✗ What happens now

The sheet has **one date column**. So people argue about what to put in it — and whichever one they pick, the other two are lost forever.

THREE PEOPLE, THREE ANSWERS

Ramesh says **2 August** — that's when he asked

Sir says **4 August** — that's when he approved it

Dhwani says **25 August** — that's when the money left

And because only one survives, nobody can later answer simple questions like “how long did this take?” or “how much money is approved but still not paid?”

✓ What we do instead

Don't pick one. Keep all of them. Think of a courier parcel — it has a booking date, a dispatch date and a delivery date. Nobody asks which one is “the” date. That would be a silly question.

WHAT HAPPENED	WHEN	WHAT THAT DATE IS USED FOR
Ramesh asked	2 Aug	Only to see how slow we are
Sir approved	4 Aug	Budget is blocked from here
Cheque written	11 Aug	Goes into the voucher book
Vendor took money	25 Aug	Goes into the CRBR

The simple rule

Money is **blocked** the day Sir signs. Money is **gone** the day the vendor takes it. The CRBR only cares about the second one.

What Dhwani sees

The CRBR row on 25 Aug reads “PRN292 — asked 2 Aug, approved 4 Aug, taken 25 Aug.” So a paper dated 2 Aug next to a CRBR row dated 25 Aug is no longer confusing.



Something this catches that nobody catches today

Sir approved ₹8,000 on 4 August. If by 20 September nobody has paid it, the system says “this money has been blocked for 47 days and never spent.” Today that just sits there quietly, eating into a site's budget for something that never happened.

Three amounts, and everyone is right

✕

What happens now

We store one amount. So the moment Sir changes ₹10,000 to ₹8,000, one of these is wrong — and two months later nobody remembers which.

Then the vendor phones and says “you still owe me ₹2,000” — and Dhwani has to go digging through files to work out whether that is true.

✓

What we do instead — keep all four numbers

Ramesh asked

₹10,000

Sir approved

₹8,000

only this one is real

We paid

₹8,000

Vendor's book

₹10,000

their claim, not our debt

🚩

The ₹2,000 gap must be explained

Dhwani ticks one of three. The PRN cannot be closed until she does.

✓

Not owed

Sir reduced the work, so ₹8,000 finishes it. Close the request, reason saved.

→

Pay later

The ₹2,000 is still owed. The system makes a small linked request for ₹2,000 so it cannot be forgotten.

⚠️

Vendor is arguing

Mark it disputed. It stays visible on the vendor's page until somebody sorts it out.

📄

Two months later, the vendor phones

Dhwani opens Shreeji Traders' page. The answer is one line — no digging.

REQUEST	THEY SAY	APPROVED	PAID	WHAT WE DECIDED
PRN292	10,000	8,000	8,000	Not owed — Sir reduced the work, 4 Aug
PRN288	45,000	45,000	45,000	Fully settled

🛡️

Better still — stop the argument starting

Half of these fights happen because Ramesh already told the vendor ₹10,000 before Sir had even seen it.

So once approved, the copy that gets shared shows ₹8,000, and Ramesh gets a message: “your ₹10,000 became ₹8,000.” Whatever the vendor is told is what was actually signed.

Delete one row, and the numbers shift up

✗ What happens now

BEFORE

PRN291 Shreeji 45,000

PRN292 Kiran 10,000

PRN293 Mehul 22,000

somebody deletes Kiran's row
(cancelled, entered twice, whatever)

AFTER

PRN291 Shreeji 45,000

PRN292 Mehul 22,000

Mehul just took
Kiran's number.
And nothing warned anybody.

⚠ Why this is the worst one

Think about what is already out there in the office with “PRN292” written on it:

- A cheque counterfoil in the file — “against PRN292, ₹10,000”
- A voucher in the folder, signed
- Sir's memory of approving PRN292
- A WhatsApp message to the vendor mentioning PRN292

Every one of those now points at Mehul's ₹22,000 instead. The sheet quietly rewrote the past, and no report will ever show you that it happened.

✓ What we do instead

Right now the number is just where the row sits. Row 292 means PRN292. Move the row, the number changes.

Instead, treat it like a bill book. Bill 292 is torn out and spoiled — you write “cancelled” across it and leave it in the book. Bill 293 does not become 292. That would be madness.

PRN291 Shreeji 45,000

PRN292 CANCELLED

PRN293 Mehul 22,000

293 stays 293.

Forever.

292 shows who cancelled it,
when, and why.

🔒 Three rules that make it impossible

- 1 **The system hands out the number once**
It keeps a counter — “last one was 293.” The next request gets 294, and that sticks to it for life. Nothing ever recalculates it.
- 2 **Nothing is deleted — it is cancelled**
Cancelling keeps the number occupied, with who did it and why. Exactly how a spoiled voucher stays in the book, crossed out.
- 3 **A gap is fine — as long as you can see why**
The screen says “292 was cancelled”, never “292 is missing”. A blank gap is frightening in an audit; a labelled cancellation is not.

The cheque that exists nowhere

✗

What happens now

You told me the CRBR is only written when the vendor actually claims the money. That is correct — but it leaves a 14-day hole.

Between 11 and 25 August the cheque is out of our hands but has no CRBR row yet. So it appears in no report at all. If the vendor loses it and never banks it, nobody ever finds out.

✓

What we do instead — a waiting list in the middle

Think of the cheque like a parcel you handed to a courier. It has left your hands, but it hasn't reached anyone yet. It isn't with you and it isn't with them. It needs its own shelf — and that shelf is the new bit.

11 August · Voucher book

Cheque 004182 written and handed over
Dhwani checks the paper here



11 – 25 August · The waiting shelf

“Given out, not yet taken” — its own screen
shows waiting 14 days against this cheque
past 30 days it turns red — “has the vendor lost it?”



25 August · CRBR

Vendor banks it, bank balance drops
the row appears by itself

Dhwani does not type this row

🕒

How long the wait is, for each way of paying

HOW WE PAID	USUAL WAIT	WHEN WE COUNT IT AS TAKEN
Cash voucher	Same day	The person signs the voucher and walks away with the cash. Written and taken on the same day.
Cheque	Days to weeks	When it shows on the bank statement. Until then it is promised, not paid.
Bank transfer	Same day	The moment it is sent. No wait at all, and no voucher book entry.

👁

What the shelf gives you

At any moment, one screen answers: “how much money have we promised but not yet actually paid?”

Today that number does not exist anywhere. Nobody can tell you it, not even roughly.

What Dhwani checks, and when

The paper is dated 11 August. The CRBR row appears on 25 August. So she checks **twice** — but for completely different things, and never the same thing twice.



11 August — she checks the paper

the day the cheque is written

- ✓ Is the signed PRN actually in the file?
- ✓ Does the cheque amount match what Sir approved?
- ✓ Is the counterfoil filed, with the right cheque number?
- ✓ Who took the cheque, and on what date?
- ✓ Is the voucher book row printed and signed?

Then she closes 11 August — without this payment in the CRBR.

That is correct. The vendor hasn't taken the money yet, so it does not belong in the day's cash or bank book.



25 August — she checks the bank

the day the money actually leaves

- ✓ Does the bank statement show cheque 004182 for ₹8,000?
- ✓ Did the CRBR row appear on its own?
- ✓ Did the waiting shelf drop by exactly ₹8,000?
- ✓ Is Shreeji Traders' outstanding now clear?

✗ She does not open the file again.

The screen already tells her: “paper checked on 11 Aug by Dhwani.”

So she never checks the same PRN twice, and never wonders whether somebody else already did.



The whole answer in one sentence

Check the paper on the day it is written. Check the bank on the day the money is taken. Never both on the same day, and never the same thing twice.

Three small checks instead of one

Today Dhwani checks one thing at day end — does the cash tally. Now she checks three, and all three work exactly the same way: what we started with, plus what came in, minus what went out.

EVENING OF 25 AUGUST

WHAT WE ARE COUNTING	STARTED WITH	CAME IN	WENT OUT	LEFT WITH	HOW SHE PROVES IT
Cash in the box	1,22,500	0	18,000	1,04,500	She counts the actual notes
Money in the bank	4,20,000	0	8,000	4,12,000	The bank statement
Cheques given but not yet taken ← this is the new one	85,000	0	8,000	77,000	The waiting shelf screen

Read the new row out loud

“Yesterday we had ₹85,000 of cheques sitting with vendors, not yet banked. Today one for ₹8,000 got banked. So ₹77,000 is still out there.”

That is the whole idea. No formula to remember — it reads like a sentence, and it is the same shape as counting cash.

And it answers a question nobody can answer today
“How much have we promised vendors but not actually paid yet?” Right now that number does not exist in any file. From here on, it is on screen every evening.

Why three checks catch what one cannot

That ₹8,000 cheque has to leave the **waiting shelf** and the **bank** on the same day, by the same amount. Two rows must move together.

If someone ticks it as taken but the bank shows nothing
The two rows disagree, and Dhwani sees it that evening.

If a cheque clears that was never recorded as written
Same thing — the shelf doesn't move, and it shows up.

The day cannot be closed until all three balance. So a mistake is found the same evening, while everyone still remembers what happened — not four weeks later at month end.

Four problems, four fixes

1

One date column, three real dates

asked 2 Aug, approved 4 Aug, paid 25 Aug



Keep every date. The CRBR uses the day the vendor took the money. Budget is blocked from the day Sir signs.

2

₹10,000, ₹8,000, and the vendor's book

everybody is telling the truth



Keep all four numbers. The gap must be ticked as not-owed, pay-later, or disputed before the request can be closed.

3

Deleting a row renumbers the rest

PRN293 quietly becomes PRN292



Numbers are handed out and stick for life. Cancel, never delete — exactly like a bill book.

4

Cheque written now, taken in two weeks

for 14 days it is in no report at all



Add a waiting shelf for cheques given but not taken — and check it every evening, just like cash.



What this changes for Dhwani

She stops copying things and starts confirming them. The paper check happens once, on the day it is written. The bank check happens once, on the day the money moves. The evening tally is three short sums instead of an argument with the sheet.

And nothing can go wrong quietly — because the day simply will not close until all three add up.



One thing to decide

For a cheque, does “taken” mean the day the vendor deposits it, or the day it actually clears our bank?

We have assumed **clears**, because that is the only one the bank statement can prove. If Dhwani's practice is different, this is a small change — but it is her call to make, not ours.